

Chapter 39-3

When she arrived at the company, as Xu Qingzhu was waiting for the elevator downstairs, her phone vibrated slightly.

Liang Shi sent a message—

【Acting is something I quite like, so I can't yield. But if you really want me to avoid Chen Liuying, I would also avoid her. I don't want my presence to cause your interpersonal relationships to become worse, it's just that I would be unhappy that way. So I'm very happy that you're letting me boldly pursue this.】

A few seconds later, there was another message—

【Teacher Xu, I forgot to say, you look super beautiful today! Fearless you will definitely be invincible! Go for it! I will definitely get the role to celebrate for you!】

Xu Qingzhu stared at the screen, confirming again and again that it was indeed sent by Liang Shi.

Looking at it, she was actually infected by the emotions in those words and couldn't help but laugh.

"Blanche, what's making you so happy so early in the morning?" Sally walked over carrying a cup of iced americano, and naturally leaned her head over to look at her screen. Xu Qingzhu immediately turned off the screen and restrained her smile, "Nothing."

"Oh?" Sally obviously didn't believe it, "Your mouth is almost stretching to the back of your ears."

Xu Qingzhu rolled her eyes at her, "What nonsense? How ugly would that make me look?"

Sally described it dramatically: "You know the big-mouthed monkey¹? Just like that."

Lin Luoxi couldn't stand it anymore and interrupted: "That's enough, you're really ugly right now."

Sally: "...Blanche was just like that, and you still said she was cute."

Lin Luoxi: "Making funny faces requires good looks. Unfortunately, you don't have that."

Sally looked hurt, "OMG, Cherry, you used to say I was the most beautiful person in this world."

Lin Luoxi with a cold face: "Don't talk to me in such a disgusting tone. Also, I used to be nearsighted at fifteen hundred degrees."

Sally: "What?"

Lin Luoxi with a death smile: "I was basically blind."

Sally: "..."

Xu Qingzhu witnessed a verbal sparring match in the elevator, and Sally was defeated as usual.

When getting out of the elevator, Xu Qingzhu consolatorily but also somewhat gloatingly patted Sally's shoulder.

Sally: "..."

She felt like she had suffered a double critical hit.

"Come to a meeting in ten minutes." Xu Qingzhu said to these two: "Also, call Zhou Yi'an."

"Okay." Lin Luoxi agreed.

After returning to the office, Xu Qingzhu reopened her phone and found that Liang Shi had sent her two more messages.

【By the way, I didn't buy that trending topic last time. I don't have money to buy trending topics.】

【If your friend calls again, just say it was something I insisted on doing and you didn't know. Tell her to call me directly.】

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but find it amusing, yet she lowered her head to tap the screen and replied: 【Where's your money?】

Liang Shi replied instantly: 【Didn't I give it all to you?】

— 【Did you think fifty thousand yuan could buy a trending topic?】

— 【Wouldn't Chen Liuying have to live on trending topics every day then?】

Xu Qingzhu: 【...】

After five seconds of silence, Xu Qingzhu transferred one hundred thousand yuan to her.

Liang Shi clicked to return it.

Liang Shi: 【I didn't mean to ask for money.】

— 【If you give it to me like this, wouldn't that make me look like an internet beggar?】

— 【If you really want to give it, I prefer cash (just kidding)】

Xu Qingzhu: 【...Not a cent left.】

Xu Qingzhu suddenly noticed: 【You seem to be talking unusually much today.】

Liang Shi: 【Sweating.jpg】

After a while, Liang Shi sent: 【Can I say that I'm a bit nervous?】

Xu Qingzhu: 【...You can.】

Liang Shi: 【What if I don't act well? What if Chen Liuying takes this role? I'll be looked down upon.】

Xu Qingzhu stared intently at the screen, thinking about how to respond appropriately.

How could she both encourage Liang Shi without hurting her self-esteem, while also making her face reality?

No matter how bad Chen Liuying was, she had still acted in two dramas. How could someone who had just barely stepped into the entertainment industry with her toes compare?

That trending topic last time—anyone with eyes could see it was bought by Chen Liuying's competitors to step on Chen Liuying, and had nothing to do with whether Liang Shi's acting was good or not.

She typed several sentences, all of which she deleted before sending.

Deleting and reducing, she surprisingly couldn't think of a single appropriate thing to say.

She kept procrastinating until Sally and Cherry came in holding their computers.

Zhou Yi'an was last, swaggering with one hand in her pocket, looking like a cool sister, but she still closed the door when she came in.

Xu Qingzhu sighed helplessly and quickly tapped the screen with her fingers: 【Impossible. Chen Liuying's acting is terrible. This role is definitely yours.】

— 【Your acting is so much better than hers. If you're not chosen, it must be underhanded dealings—the director has poor judgment.】

The moment those two messages were sent, Xu Qingzhu suddenly felt like she was a master at making empty promises.

But most importantly, she felt that the truth wasn't so important anymore.

At times like this, it was better to be blindly protective.

After all... she was one of her own people.

Footnotes: ¹ Big-mouthed monkey: Refers to a cartoon character or emoji with an exaggeratedly wide smile, used here as a humorous comparison